

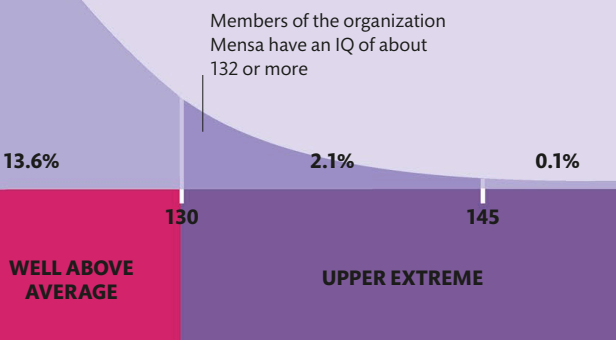
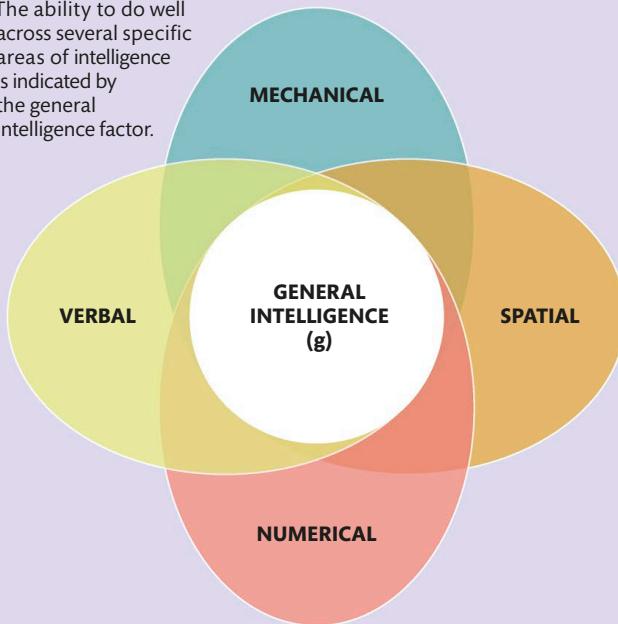


Alternatives to IQ

IQ is not the only measure of intelligence. There are several alternatives, many of which are more visually based, with pictures, illusions, or pattern sequences at their core. Psychometric testing is an approach often used in job recruitment to assess a person's aptitudes—for example, to evaluate empathy when selecting a carer. People who score well on IQ tests are also likely to score well on other tests. This probably indicates a high level of overall cognitive ability, sometimes referred to as general intelligence factor (g).

General intelligence

The ability to do well across several specific areas of intelligence is indicated by the general intelligence factor.



RECORD IQS

Claims of exceptional IQs (including scores over 200) are often made but rarely verified. The American Marilyn vos Savant held the IQ record (228) in the Guinness World Records from 1986 to 1989, after which Guinness retired the category because it concluded the tests were not reliable enough. Attempts have also been made to measure the IQs of people who can no longer be tested. Albert Einstein, for example, is estimated to have had an IQ of over 160.



Is IQ on the rise?

There is evidence for a widespread increase in IQ. When IQ tests are revised every 10–20 years, the test-takers who are used to standardize the new test are asked to take the previous test as well, and they consistently score higher on the old test. In other words, if American adults today took an IQ test from the 1920s, the vast majority would score in the upper extreme, above 130. This is supported by evidence from around the world, although the rate of increase is most rapid in developing countries. Recent evidence suggests that this rise, known as the Flynn effect, has started to plateau.

